STUDIO NPV · BRAND GUIDELINES · V2.0 · OCTOBER 2026

Indigo & *Marigold*

Neel and genda. Indigo is the oldest dye India gave the world: deep, steady and trustworthy. Marigold is the colour of beginnings: warm, local and impossible to ignore. Together they say a senior builder from Bengaluru who is good company.

classy on the page, fun in the margin

01 · IDEA

A page, and a *margin*

Founders hiring a solo builder ask two things: can I trust this person with my idea, and will working with them feel human? The page answers the first with structure, real numbers, fixed prices and strong colour blocks. The margin answers the second with pen notes in sindoor red and marigold circles, like someone marked up your plan.

The brand tells the story of a project: napkin, then scope, then shipped. The hand is loudest at the start and quietest at the end. Finished things look finished.

02 · COLOUR

The palette

Two brand colours, one pen, three neutrals. Every text pairing below passes WCAG AA (4.5:1) and was checked.

Neel

White text 12.0:1

Indigo #232C82

Hero and contact bands, primary buttons, numbers

Genda

Deep Neel text 8.9:1

Marigold #F5B53F

Buttons on indigo, pen circles, active states

Sindoor

On Kagaz 4.6:1

Vermilion #C2401E

Handwritten notes, strike-throughs, low scores

Deep Neel

White text 16.1:1

Deep indigo #161B4F

Footer, text on marigold

Kagaz

Ink text 15.2:1

Paper #F4F2EC

The page background

Haldi

Ink text 14.3:1

Turmeric wash #FCE9C2

Warm bands, aside, pills

Syahi

On Kagaz 15.2:1

Ink #171A33

Body text and headlines

Slate

On Kagaz 6.0:1

Slate #555A78

Secondary text, labels

PROPORTION ACROSS A PAGE



~50% Kagaz · ~25% Neel bands · ~12% Haldi · Ink text · Marigold as accent · Sindoor only in the margin

HALDI BAND

For proof and next steps

notes in sindoor

DARK MODE

Background #10143A, cards #1A1F4D, text #EEF0FB, secondary #AEB3D8. Marigold becomes the accent and the button colour; notes use a lighter sindoor, #FF8F6B.

04 · WORDMARK

The wordmark

studio *npv*

studio *npv*

studio *npv*

CONSTRUCTION

“studio” in Instrument Sans Medium; “npv” in Instrument Serif Italic at 1.35× the size, on a shared baseline, in the accent colour of its background. Lowercase, always.

NEVER	Never drawn by hand, circled, or set in Kalam. The wordmark belongs to the page, not the margin.

05 · TYPE

Three voices, three typefaces

DISPLAY · INSTRUMENT SERIF	Software people *use*.
USE	Headlines, big numbers, step numerals, FAQ questions, post titles. The italic word takes the accent colour. Never below 22px.
PAGE · INSTRUMENT SANS	I design and build software for founders and small businesses, for a fixed price agreed before work starts.
USE	Body 17/1.6, small 14–15, labels 12 uppercase at 0.1em tracking. Every button, field and nav item.
MARGIN · KALAM LIGHT	*the price is set here, once*
USE	Margin notes only: sindoor on Kagaz, marigold on Neel, 18–24px, one short line. Kalam is by the Indian Type Foundry and has Devanagari, so it can carry a Hindi or Kannada-script note later.

06 · THE MARGIN

Four pen marks, used *sparingly*

This is the whole budget for fun. One mark per screen view. If a mark doesn't point at something true and specific, delete it.

CIRCLE · MARIGOLD

From a napkin sketch

For the one word a page is about. Hero headlines only.

UNDERLINE · MARIGOLD

One fixed price

For a promise. One section heading per page.

MARGIN NOTE · SINDOOR

a few lines is enough to start

An aside in your voice, beside what it explains. Under eight words.

CORRECTION · SINDOOR

~~hourly billing~~

For what the studio doesn't do, or what waits until later. Rare.

MOTION

Circles and underlines draw on once, 900ms. Nothing loops. With reduced motion turned on they're simply there. Marks are absolutely positioned, so they never shift layout.

07 · CONTROLS

Buttons, links and fields

Controls belong to the page, never the margin: round, exact, never drawn. Primary is Neel on Kagaz and Marigold on Neel; hover swaps to the other brand colour.

Tell me about your idea →

Secondary action

Text link →

On a Neel band →

Text link →

SIZES	48px tall pills (44px minimum touch target), 24px side padding, Instrument Sans Medium 15px, optional →. One primary per view. Links get a 1.5px marigold underline.

Field label

12px radius, 50px tall

Focus: Neel border plus a 3px Haldi ring. Labels always visible above the field.

08 · LAYOUT

Rhythm and colour blocks

PAGE RHYTHM	Neel hero → Kagaz sections → a Haldi band for proof → Kagaz → Neel contact band → Deep Neel footer. Every page opens on a colour block, and no stretch of plain paper runs longer than about two screens.
SPACING	8px base. Sections 72px apart on desktop, 48px on phones. A 200px label rail on desktop; everything stacks at phone width with a 20px gutter.
SURFACES	White cards with a 1px border and 16px radius for grouped items. Panels sitting on Neel (forms, the product demo) get a soft deep shadow. 999px radius for buttons.

IMAGERY	One real portrait, ideally on a marigold or indigo backdrop. No stock photos, no illustrated people, no gradients or glows.
UI LIBRARY PICKS	Accordion (shadcn) for FAQs · Sheet (shadcn) for the phone menu · Stateful Button (Aceternity) for forms · Timeline (Aceternity), static, on About.

Do and don't

DO

- Open every page on a Neel block
- Use one pen mark per view, pointing at something true
- Keep finished UI crisp; the hand belongs to drafts and notes
- Check every page in dark mode and at 390px

DON'T

- Draw buttons, fields or the wordmark by hand
- Put marigold text on Kagaz (it fails contrast)
- Add gradients, glows, emoji or stock imagery
- Animate anything that loops or follows the cursor